

newly refurbished car with perfect suspension, for half the price of the new car... While you're deciding on whether this is fair or not, someone who drove their car into a tree, and then rolled down a bank into a river comes in, and get's the same offer... newly refurbished car, for half the price of a new car...

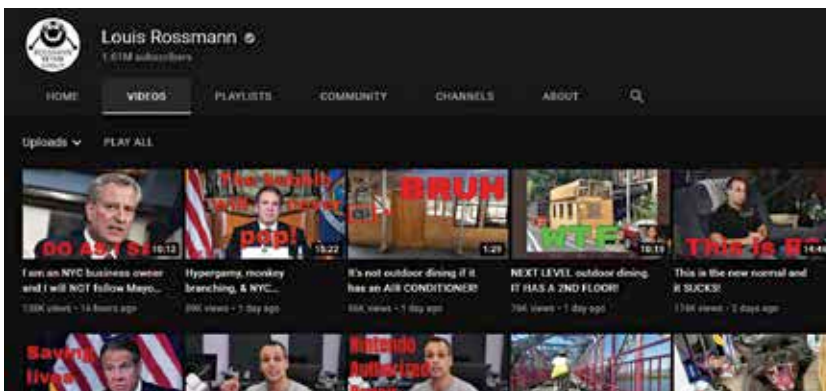
"Wait-a-gosh-darn-minute!" you complain. Mine just has a broken suspension, and I have to pay the same as this other guy who nearly totalled his car and rendered it unfixable? That's currently the way the "official" phone repair market works!

that for safety and making sure the tractor stays compliant with emissions laws, that all of its tractors had to be repaired only by John Deere authorised technicians. These are tractors that cost crores of rupees, so you can understand why farmers were irritated with this change. The last thing you want as a farmer is to have to suffer downtime waiting for an authorised technician to get time to come down to your farm and repair your tractor.

Several court cases and lobbying later, it was this farmer protest (especially in the US) which led to

Now, as we mentioned, since most of us do not want to do that, why should we care about the right to repair? This is to do with choices. Should you, as the owner of your phone, be allowed to approach a friend, a repair shop, or a manufacturer to repair your device, and then be allowed to choose whichever one of those options suits you the best. For this to occur, a manufacturer of a phone has to make the parts widely available, and in an ideal world, tell you which part does what, and create manuals for repair technicians.

However, most brands have watertight agreements with companies that manufacture parts for them, which forbid manufacturers from selling that part to anyone but the company. The brand will then decide which parts can be made accessible to which "authorised" service companies. These are often simpler repairs, such as whole screen replacements or whole battery replacements. Can you, an individual, buy a battery from your phone manufacturer? Most likely not. Unless you opted for a brand that specifically makes parts easily available, the trend in the electronics industry is leading away from repair.



A third-party repair shop owner and YouTuber who has risen to fame via the Right to Repair movement, even appearing in front of legislators in the US.

Explicit language warning: Louis Rossmann is a New Yorker, and talks like one.

TRACTORS?

While the right to repair movement has been around for some time now, especially when it comes to the hobby or DIY community, it was brought to the headlines by farmers who had to hack their tractors just to be able to continue farming.

As we've seen, technology means everything gets more and more complex and complicated as years go by, and while this is often a good thing, as our devices are able to accomplish more than most of us thought possible, it also means that repairing them has become a nightmare. Farmers across the developed world, including in the US and Australia were left in the lurch a little when John Deere, the famous tractor company, changed its end-user license agreement in 2016 that basically forbade farmers from trying to fix their own tractors or get local repair technicians to do so. It insisted

US President Joe Biden releasing an executive order allowing farmers to repair their own tractors. This small win for the farmer is now being seen, finally, as light at the end of the tunnel for the right to repair movement. RoR has been demanding this freedom for years for many other industries as well, most importantly, in electronics and gadgets, which is why Digit is so interested in this topic, as we hope, are you.

RIGHT TO REPAIR

Put simply, the right to repair movement demands that you as a consumer, be allowed to repair your own device, at your own risk, and be allowed to buy all the knowledge and parts that you need to be able to do so. While 99.99% of the population would never think of opening up their phone or TV, or any gadget, to try and repair it, the movement insists that it is your right to do so, if you so desire.

CONFLICT OF INTEREST

Another major pushback of the right to repair movement is based on how leaving both the manufacturing and service of products to any brand gives them too much power over consumers. Left to a company whose major concern is their bottomline and share prices, what's profitable is what will always be chosen. There has to be some form of balance in the supply chain and life cycle of products, starting right from manufacturing, all the way until the moment that product is recycled or junked.

As is happening now, many manufacturers of many different kinds of products are trying to make repairs so expensive that buying a new device seems like a no-brainer solution for most people. This encourages a use and throw mentality in us consumers, which is perfect for the industry as a whole to grow. All of this growth is good for innovation and the like, but it